

richarddecrep

Hi, I'm Richard the Crepney, and I'm the patron of Disabled Winter Sport Australia. The incident that happened when QF32 had the engine failure in Singapore, it was pretty well an event that was reported worldwide, so I have a pulpit, at least, where I can garnish interest and support, so I was asked to be patron of DWA to lend some help and to bring some foreign interest in, and we're here at Perisher Mountain, the wonderful Perisher. We've got the Army, Navy and Air Force ski teams here.

I skied with the Air Force 30 years ago with the Air Force ski team in New South Wales, so it's great to be back here with these racers, and we have the Army, Navy and Air Force mixing in with Disabled Winter Sport. It's a beautiful support ring, and it's my privilege to be here as patron of DWA. Disabled Winter Sport Australia was formed in 1987 when some instructors at Thredbo decided to bring together the people who had physical or mental limited abilities, and we can bring them on the snow, and we can help them feel the wind rush through their hair because some people have not felt the hair in the wind, and we can give them the confidence to be courageous on the snow, build up their confidence, and through that we help them realise potentials that they never knew that existed.

So we take people with limited abilities, and we turbo charge them, and we change their lives, and it's a privilege to be part of that. Oh, it's been a great privilege to meet Michael Melton, he's Australia's fastest skier. He has one leg, and here is someone who has taken a challenge and made the most of that, and he's now a multi-metal winner in the Paralympics.

He's a fastest skier in Australia, and he's a mentor, I think, for anyone who has suffered a loss of ability that through DWA support, with the volunteer support, that you can achieve great things. We have about 800 disabled skiers that are members of DWA, we have about 250 volunteers that come and help, and we welcome more people who need the support of DWA, and we certainly welcome volunteers, it might be from the military, it could be from airlines or any particular group, we have people in the car industry, some of the car industries coming to help us, we welcome as many volunteers as we can get, we need you all, and the people who do volunteer their time, they come back and say, this is a new dimension to skiing that they've never had before, some people have skied for 30 years, but they've never actually used their skill to help someone else that needs it. So we have a pairing of an experience with someone who needs some help, and both people benefit out of the system.

DWA is really one of the most remarkable charities in Australia. There's a wonderful website at disabledwintersports.com.au, all the information is there, you can become a member pretty well immediately, and you can come and volunteer, come out and join us where at all mountains, which is Thredbo, Perisher, Hotham, Bulla and Falls Creek, so wherever you wish to ski or wherever you wish to turbocharge your abilities and discover something which you had not realised to be in your potential before, come to the mountains, join in with DWA, and let's achieve

great things. Hi, I'm Richard the Crepney, I'm the patron of Disabled Winter Sport Australia, and you're watching DWA TV.